

TITLE: Password and Account Security Policy

ORGANIZATION: Northwind Analytics, Inc.

DEPARTMENT: IT

SENSITIVITY: Internal

VERSION: 1.0

EFFECTIVE_DATE: 2023-03-01

Password and Account Security Policy

1. Password Requirements

Requirement	Standard
Minimum length	8 characters
Complexity	At least one number and one special character
Rotation	Changed every 90 days

All corporate accounts must meet these requirements at all times. Passwords that no longer meet the minimum standard are rejected at the next mandatory rotation.

2. Multi-Factor Authentication

System	MFA Status
Finance systems	Required
HR systems	Required
Email	Optional (recommended)
General applications	Optional (recommended)

3. Account Lockout

Accounts are locked after 5 failed login attempts and must be unlocked by the IT Helpdesk. There is no self-service unlock option under this version of the policy.

VPN Connection Troubleshooting Flow

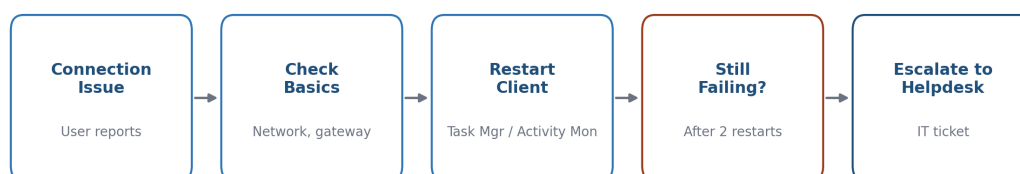


Figure 1: Related VPN authentication also relies on these same account credentials -- see the VPN Access and Troubleshooting Guide for the connection flow.

4. Frequently Asked Questions

What happens if I forget to change my password before the 90-day deadline?

The system will prompt you to change it at your next login after the 90-day mark; repeated non-compliance may result in account suspension pending a password reset.

Why is MFA not required for email under this policy?

As of this version, MFA is scoped to finance and HR systems specifically, reflecting the risk assessment at the time this policy was written. This scope was later expanded -- see Version History below.

5. Version History

Version	Effective Date	Summary
1.0	2023-03-01	Initial policy: 8-char minimum, 90-day rotation, MFA scoped to finance/HR only
2.0	2026-02-01	Superseding version: 12-char minimum, rotation removed, MFA mandatory for all accounts -- see current policy

6. Contact

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